

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting case management, client advice and document preparation across disputes, welfare, housing and employment matters. At Citizens Advice East Berkshire I manage a varied caseload of vulnerable clients from instruction through to submission, handling confidential case records, correspondence and procedural deadlines. Prior experience at BCLP included preparing hearing bundles, tracking procedural deadlines, reviewing evidence and coordinating court filings across arbitration and real estate disputes. Strong written communication and legal research skills, with a focus on translating complex legal requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules covering international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural law, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Assesses eligibility for Universal Credit, Housing Benefit and related support against statutory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex regulatory points
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across a varied active caseload
- Translates complex procedural rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients, adapting communication to individual needs and circumstances

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended memorial sections and drafted procedural orders and histories
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Prepared client notes; maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements and deadline tracking
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, and translated statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused written advice
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; qualitative client interviewing; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, confidential case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters